Gods of SPLORR!!

Player's guide

You are a god

Five people wake up in a small world of grass, trees, berry bushes, ponds and stone. They do not know you are there. Left alone, they forage, make tools, fish, hunt rabbits, build a fire, sew fur coats and dry food for the winter. Some years that is enough. Many years it is not.

You watch over them, and you have **faith** to spend on **miracles**: you can feed them, grow them food, or, if you are that kind of god, send snakes and smite them. The game ends when the last of your people dies, and it tells you how long they lasted. Your aim is to make that as long as you can, or to see what happens when you don't.

The game opens late in spring. Summer is the time of plenty; the winter after it is long, freezing and berry-less, and it is where most tribes are lost.

The screen



The game in early summer, following the tribe's hunter (white frame). Left: the clock and the miracles. Middle: the map; the yellow frame is your cursor. Right: the minimap, view buttons and the status panel describing the person being followed.

Part	What it shows
Clock (top left)	Year, month and day; the time and season; the temperature; the game speed (or *paused*); and your faith.
Miracles (left)	One button per miracle with its key and faith cost. A button you cannot afford is dimmed.
Map (middle)	Part of the world. The yellow square is your cursor; a white frame marks the person you are following. The map darkens at night.
Minimap (top right)	The whole world, with a white box for what the map shows. Click or drag on it to look somewhere else.
Buttons (right)	Zoom in and out, follow or stop following, follow the next person, and the menu.
Status panel (right)	What is under the cursor, or everything about the person you are following.

Reading the map

You see	It is
People	Your tribe, coloured by skin. A corpse lies where someone died and slowly rots to a skeleton.
Bushes, red bar	A berry bush; the red bar is how full of berries it is. An orange bar above means the bush has been damaged by clumsy picking; at zero it is destroyed.
Ponds, green bar	A pond with fish; the green bar is how many reeds are left to cut.
Trees, grass, grey stone	Sticks, fiber and stone: the raw materials for everything your people make.
Rabbits	Grey-white rabbits graze the grass and bolt from people. Your hunter spears them for meat and fur.
Snakes	Only when you send one: they hunt people and poison them.
Small squares	Things on the ground, such as stones, sticks, tools, fish, food drying on a rack. Most of them pile up at the tribe's **stockpile**, their home.

Controls

Keyboard	Mouse	Does
`Arrows` / `WASD` (`Shift`: 5 cells)	Hover	Move the cursor and inspect what is under it
	Drag the map	Pan the view
`Z` / `X`	Wheel, Zoom buttons	Zoom in / out (5 cells across at the closest)
`F`	Click a person	Follow them: the view stays on them and the status panel describes them. Moving the cursor or panning stops following.
`N`	Next button	Follow the next person
	Click the minimap	Look there
`1`-`5`	Miracle buttons	A key casts that miracle at the cursor at once; a button arms it, and your next click on the map casts it there
`Esc`		Disarm a miracle, close the menu
`Space`		Pause and resume
`+` / `-`		Game speed, from 0.25x to 32x
`P`	Miracles button	Show or hide the miracle buttons
`M`, `H` or `C`	Menu button	Controls and credits
`R`	Click	Begin again once everyone is dead

Playing with a gamepad

The whole game plays from the d-pad (or left stick) and two buttons:

Button	Does
D-pad	Moves the cursor (hold it to keep moving). In the command menu, picks a line.
A	Acts at the cursor: casts the armed miracle there; otherwise follows the person under the cursor, or lets go of the one you are following. After a loss, begins again. In the command menu, runs the chosen line.
B	Opens the command menu, or disarms an armed miracle. In the menu, closes it.

The command menu lists the five miracles (choosing one arms it, ready for A), follow someone or the next person, stop following, zoom in and out, faster and slower, pause, and the controls and credits. Zoom and speed leave the menu open, so you can press A again. While you follow someone the cursor stays on them, so A or an armed miracle acts on that person. As shortcuts, the bumpers change speed and Start pauses.

At normal speed (1x) a game day takes 24 real minutes, so an hour passes every minute. Speed it up to watch a season go by, and slow down or pause when something needs your attention.

Miracles

Faith starts at 50, refills by 2 every game hour and holds at most 100. There are two ways to cast one: put the cursor on a cell and press the miracle's number key, or click its button to arm it (the button lights up) and then click the cell. An armed miracle stays armed, so every click casts it again until you click the button again or press `Esc`. On a gamepad, press B, choose the miracle, then move the cursor and press A; B disarms it. A miracle with nothing to act on (Smite on an empty cell, say) costs nothing and does nothing.



Miracle Bush armed (the lit button): the next click on the map grows one there.

Key	Miracle	Faith	What it does
1	Manna	10	Drops a berry on any open cell. Cheap and quick: drop it beside someone starving.
2	Smite	30	Kills the person on that cell.
3	Snake	25	A poisonous snake that hunts anyone within 6 cells for 3 days. Poison drains health for hours; people run unless they hold a spear, and a spear can kill it.
4	Smite Bush	15	Burns a bush away, leaving bare dirt.
5	Miracle Bush	40	Grows a bush that holds up to 20 berries, regrows three times as fast, and bears even in winter.

Watching your people

Click a person (or press N) to follow them. The status panel then shows:

Line	Meaning
Health	0 to 100. At zero they die. Health lost to hunger, cold or poison does not come back.
Satiety, Stomach	Food eaten goes into the stomach and is digested into satiety. With an empty stomach satiety falls; at zero satiety they starve, losing health. Under 60 satiety they drop everything to look for food.
Energy, Sleeps	Energy runs down while awake; they sleep about as many hours a night as shown.
Carrying	Things in hand, out of how many they can carry (a belt adds more).
Skills	Foraging, crafting, ranged (spear), fishing and cooking. Higher is better; the number in brackets is experience that adds to it.
Doing, Role	What they are doing right now, and their job in the tribe.
Chill, Heat, Hypothermia, Heat stress	Shown when they are cold or hot. A full load of chill turns into hypothermia, which costs health.
Age, Mood	How old they are of the age they will die at, and how happy they are.
Crafted, tool uses, coat	What they have made, how many uses their tools have left, and whether they wear a fur coat.

How your tribe gets through the year

Jobs

Your people share out the work by what each is best at, and take new jobs whenever someone dies. Everyone eats first when they are hungry.

Role	Work
Forager	Carries fiber, stone and sticks home to the stockpile, and picks berries for the winter.
Toolmaker	Makes the tribe's tools: a sharp stone, net, spear, fire drill, cooking stick and drying racks. Skins rabbits and sews fur coats.
Firekeeper	Builds the fire pit at home, lights it when it is cold, cooks fish and meat, and dries meat when there is no fire.
Fisher	Fishes the ponds with the net and brings the catch home.
Hunter	Spears rabbits (leaving enough to breed) and brings them home to be skinned.

A tribe reduced to one person has no roles: the survivor does a little of everything.

Summer: laying in

While berries grow, your people hang berries and raw meat on drying racks at the stockpile. After a day they become dried food, which never goes bad. Nobody touches the store until winter, unless they are starving. A tribe needs a few hundred pieces each to last the winter.

Winter: holding on

From about the eighth month the berries stop and the nights fall well below freezing. People in fur coats hardly feel the cold; the rest crowd round the fire. They live on the dried store, fish and cooked meat until spring.



Winter at the camp. Everyone wears a fur coat; the rows of small squares are the tribe's stockpile and its store of dried food.

Tips for a god

> **The first year decides everything.** In testing with no miracles, every tribe that lived through its first winter lasted three years or more. The tribes that die go in two ways: a world too poor in berry bushes to feed five people through the first summer, or a store too small for the first winter.

- **Look at the bushes early.** If the minimap shows few bushes near the tribe, plant a **Miracle Bush** near their home. It keeps bearing through the winter, when nothing else does.
- **Save faith for winter.** Faith tops out at 100, so spend it before it is wasted in summer, but keep enough for **Manna** when people start to starve in the cold.
- **Follow the toolmaker** to see how the tribe is doing: what has been made, and whether there are coats for everyone.
- **Snakes are dangerous to everyone.** A bite costs about half a person's health. Only send one if you mean it, or to give your hunter something to do.
- **Speed up the quiet times.** Summer runs itself; run it at 8x or more, then slow down as autumn comes.

Changing the world

Options can be added to the game's web address, for example `?lat=20&day=600`:

Option	Effect	Default
`day=`	Real seconds per game day	1440 (24 minutes)
`lat=`	Latitude in degrees: lower is warmer with milder winters	40
`dpm=`, `mpy=`	Days per month, months per year	30, 12
`world=`	World size: a number for an N by N world, or `screen` for a small one	32

Credits

Code and design by the developer, with Claude, an AI agent. Tiles from the Urizen 1-bit tileset v2.0 by vurmux (CC0). Built with Odin, running as WebAssembly. For the rules and numbers behind the simulation, see the companion document *How the game works*.